

Kenenisa Tadesse Dame

CURRICULUM VITAE

PhD Candidate in Statistical Sciences at the University of Padova. Research focuses on pharmacovigilance and advanced statistical methods for drug safety monitoring, integrating biomedical NLP and machine learning, including transformer-based models (CamemBERT-Bio) and rule-based/regex information extraction. Currently a Visiting Researcher at CHU de Bordeaux working on biomedical NLP for narrative-coding alignment in ICSRs to support ADR signal detection and MedDRA coding quality assurance.

Contact Information

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 GitHub

Work Experience

Jan 2026 – Jun 2026

Visiting Researcher

CRPV Bordeaux-DROM, CHU de Bordeaux, France

Focus: Biomedical NLP and pharmacovigilance

Supervisor: Prof. Francesco Salvo

September 2024 – February 2025

Visiting Training

Centro Regionale di Farmacovigilanza del Veneto (CRFV Veneto)

University of Verona, Department of Diagnostics and Public Health, Italy

Focus: Pharmacovigilance and drug safety analytics

Supervisor: Prof. Ugo Moretti

2018–2023

Lecturer

Department of Statistics, Jimma University, Ethiopia

Responsible for course development, student assessment, and academic advising

Supervised undergraduate theses

2019–2023

Part-Time Lecturer

Rift Valley University, Jimma Campus, Ethiopia

Delivered specialized statistics courses for business and health science programs

2015–2016

Graduate Assistant I

Department of Statistics, Jimma University, Ethiopia

Supported departmental teaching activities through lab instruction and student tutoring

Education

2023–Present

PhD in Statistical Sciences

University of Padova, Italy

Thesis: “Advanced Statistical Methods and Models for Monitoring Drug Safety”

Supervisor: Prof. Alessandra R. Brazzale

Co-supervisors: Prof. Ugo Moretti, Dr. Pietro Belloni, Prof. Francesco Salvo

2016–2018

M.Sc. in Statistics (Biostatistics)

East China Normal University, Shanghai, China

Thesis: “A Bayesian Stochastic Gradient Descent Method”

Supervisor: Prof. Jin Xu

2012–2015

B.Sc. in Statistics

Jimma University, Ethiopia

Thesis: “Time Series Analysis on Water and Irrigation Development”

Supervisor: Dr. Sisay Wondaya

March–August 2021

Higher Diploma Program for Higher Education Academics

Jimma University, Ethiopia

Awards and Scholarships

2016–2018

China Scholarship Council

East China Normal University, Shanghai, China

2015

Academic Excellence Award

Jimma University, Ethiopia

Skills

Professional

Theoretical and applied statistics (clinical data analysis), Machine Learning & Data Mining, Pharmacoepidemiology & Drug Safety, Text Mining & NLP (transformers, sentiment analysis), Survival Analysis.

Programming languages and softwares

- Statistical Software: R, Python, SAS, STATA, Minitab, SPSS, EPI INFO

- NLP and ML Libraries: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers
- Programming: LaTeX, Microsoft Office Suite
- Version Control: GitHub
- Data Analysis: Advanced statistical modeling and computational statistics

Language Skills

- Afan Oromo: native
- Amharic: native
- English: fluent (C1)
- Chinese: beginner
- Italian: beginner

Publications

Preprint (Submitted to *Statistics in Medicine*)

K. T. Dame, P. Belloni, U. Moretti, F. Scapini, M. Tuccori, A. R. Brazzale. Advances in Ontology-Based Mining of Adverse Drug Reactions. arXiv preprint (2025). <https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.11452v1>.

Articles in Journals

1. Fufa, D.B., Diriba, T.A., Dame, K.T., et al. (2023). Competing risk models to evaluate the factors for time to loss to follow-up among tuberculosis patients at Ambo General Hospital. *BMC Public Health*. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13690-023-01130-2>
2. Ashine, T., Muleta, G., & Tadesse, K. (2021). Assessing survival time of heart failure patients: using Bayesian approach. *Journal of Big Data*. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s40537-021-00537-4>
3. Angasu, K., Bekela, T., Gelan, M., Wakjira, D., Melkamu, E., Belachew, B., Diribsa, T., Awol, A.A., Eba, A., & Tadesse, K. (2021). COVID-19's negative impacts on clinical learning and proposed compensation mechanisms among undergraduate midwifery and nursing students of Jimma University. *Advances in Medical Education and Practice*. https://www.dovepress.com/articles.php?article_id=71202
4. Getachew, M., Habtamu, R., Kifle, D., Sisay, K., Tadesse, K., Muleta, G. (2020). Modeling time to blindness of glaucoma patients: A case study at Jimma University Medical Center. *Journal of Research in Health Sciences*. <http://jrhs.umsha.ac.ir/index.php/JRHS/article/view/7514>
5. Dame, K.T., Kitaba, K.A., Negesa, E.H. (2023). Spontaneous abortion and associated factors among reproductive-age women in Bench Maji, Kefa, and Sheka Zone, Southwest Ethiopia: Institution-based cross-sectional study. *International Journal of Childbirth*. <https://connect.springerpub.com/content/sgrijc/early/2023/02/20/ijc-2022-0021>

Chapters in Books

Dame, K.T., Belloni, P., Moretti, U., Scapini, F., Tuccori, M., & Brazzale, A.R. (2025). Exploring

ontology-based mining of ADRs. In: di Bella, E., Gioia, V., Lagazio, C., Zaccarin, S. (eds) *Statistics for Innovation IV*. SIS 2025. Italian Statistical Society Series on Advances in Statistics. Springer, Cham. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-96033-8_63

Conference Presentations (as speaker)

Dame, K.T., Belloni, P., Moretti, U., Scapini, F., Tuccori, M., & Brazzale, A.R. (2025). Exploring ontology-based mining of ADRs. *Statistics for Innovation IV*, Genova, Italy, June 16-18, 2025.

Conference Papers (Accepted)

K. T. Dame, F. Salvo, P. Belloni, L. Crupi, U. Moretti, C. Cholle, A. R. Brazzale. Fine-Tuned CamemBERT-Bio Models to Verify MedDRA Coding Related to Guillain-Barré Syndrome in Individual Case Safety Reports Database. Accepted for presentation at a scientific congress (September 2026).

Conference Participation

1. The Role of Statistics for National Development in the past, Present and in the future perspective of Ethiopia. *30th Annual Conference of Ethiopian Statistical Association (ESA)*, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, May 21-22, 2022.

2. Advanced Statistical Methods for Solving Challenging Problems in Africa. *6th African International Conference on Statistics*, Arsi University in collaboration with University of Maryland Baltimore County, Adama, Ethiopia, May 25-28, 2019.

3. Enhancing the quality of Data for Sustainable Development in Ethiopia. *28th Annual Conference of Ethiopian Statistical Association (ESA)*, Bahir Dar University, Bahir Dar, Ethiopia, March 9-10, 2019.

4. Appraisal of African Statistical Associations (AfSA) and 1st International Statistical Conference in Ethiopia. *25th Anniversary of Ethiopian Statistical Association (ESA)*, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, May 20-22, 2016.

Teaching Experience

2018–2023

Jimma University, Ethiopia

Courses: Statistical Inference I & II, Multivariate Analysis I, Theory of Probability, Sample Survey Methods, Statistical Methods, Introductory Statistics, Time Series Analysis, Biostatistics and Epidemiology, Statistical Computing I & II

2019–2023

Rift Valley University, Jimma Campus, Ethiopia

Courses: Regression Analysis, Business Statistics, Biostatistics

Academic Service

2020–Present

Copy Editor

Ethiopian Journal of Education and Sciences

Provided editorial and statistical content review

References

Prof. Alessandra R. Brazzale

University of Padova

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Prof. Francesco Salvo

CRPV Bordeaux-DROM, CHU de Bordeaux

Service de Pharmacologie Médicale

Bordeaux, France

e-mail: `francesco.salvo@u-bordeaux.fr`

Prof. Jin Xu

East China Normal University

Department of Statistics

Shanghai, China

e-mail: `jxu@stat.ecnu.edu.cn`